



Late payment email to a client: 12 replies by excuse

Last checked 5 October 2026. Fill in the [BRACKETS] with your own facts.

I never received the invoice

"I never received the invoice": resend

Thank you for letting me know. I am attaching invoice [NUMBER] again. Could you confirm it has reached the right person? Payment is due by [NEW DATE].

"I never received the invoice": who pays?

I sent it to [ADDRESS] on [DATE]. If someone else handles payments, tell me who and I will send it to them.

"The payment is on its way"

Ask when it was sent

Thank you. Can you tell me the date it was sent and how, so I can look for it? If it has not reached me by [DATE], I will write again.

Promise to confirm

Thank you. When it arrives I will confirm by return.

"We have a problem with the work"

Ask which part

Thank you for telling me. Which part of the work is the problem, and what would you like me to do? Please pay the undisputed amount of [AMOUNT] by [DATE] while we talk.

Offer to look again

I am glad to look at the work again. Can you send me the details by [DATE]? The rest of the invoice is not in doubt, so please pay [AMOUNT] by [DATE].

"We are waiting for our client to pay us"

Keep it separate

I understand. My invoice is for work I finished on [DATE] and is separate from your own client's payment. Please pay by [NEW DATE]. If a plan would help, tell me.

"Cash is tight"

Offer two payments

Thank you for being straight with me. I can accept [AMOUNT] now and [AMOUNT] on [DATE]. Please reply to confirm and I will note it.

Wait if confirmed in writing

I can wait until [DATE] if you confirm in writing today. After that I will need to add interest, as set out in the terms. [ADD IF TRUE]

"The person who approves it is away"

Ask who can approve

Thank you. Who can approve it in the meantime? Please pass on invoice [NUMBER] and let me have a date.

"We will pay when the project ends"

Point to the agreement

The agreement says payment is due [TERMS]. If something has changed, I need it confirmed in writing. Otherwise please pay by [DATE].

No answer after an excuse

Say when you will write again

I have not heard further on invoice [NUMBER]. I will write on [DATE] with a final request, and I would rather settle this before then.

<https://proskillpacks.github.io/freelance/late-payment-email-to-a-client/>

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